

while acknowledging India's window of opportunity, Thiaga Rajan pointed to great disparity between states like Tamil Nadu and those in the north, which have a fertility rate of over three. "So there, unless you can create job opportunities fast enough, you are going to have problems," he warned. Kant said the average age of an Indian would be 29 right till 2070. There was a need for formal jobs. "You need to move people from agriculture to a very sustainable urbanisation," he said.

Kant detailed how India had leapfrogged in financial inclusion and digital penetration. India does 11 times more digital payments than the US and Europe and four times more than China. Thiaga Rajan, however, pointed to a dichotomy—the digital divide and lack of universal access persisted, even in an urbanised state like Tamil Nadu. He said the same about the downside of globalisation: how rapid growth would lead to an increase in inequality and social stratification. ■

P. THIAGA RAJAN
Finance Minister, Tamil Nadu

The more you have robust, independent institutions, the more you have a vibrant opposition. The more there is accountability, the more likely you will not just get a better society but also better economy

The downside of globalisation is that unless governments are focused on it, such a rapid increase in growth will also lead to increase in inequality

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- India's size and demography provide it with a massive scale. If you provide 300 million houses in the country, it is like providing houses to every Australian
- Many states, especially those in the eastern part of the country, need to move towards manufacturing-led urbanisation. Urbanisation creates better quality of life
- Industries and private sector must pay higher wage rate to skilled workers like in countries where skilled workers are used as apprentices in the manufacturing process
- India needs to grow at a rate of over 8 per cent annually for the next three years to lift a young population above the poverty line
- Economies of the future will be driven by electric mobility, battery storage and mobile manufacturing. The world will see a massive disruption in sunrise areas of growth